Proteins

Exam code: 0620 & 0971

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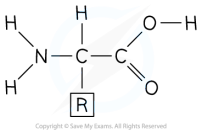
Proteins

Extended tier only

- Proteins are an example of **condensation** polymers
- They are formed from **amino acid** monomers joined together by **amide** links
- Amino acids are small molecules containing **NH_2** and **COOH** functional groups
- Due to containing amide links and being found in biological systems, proteins are known as **natural polyamides**
- In proteins, the amide links are known as peptide links
- There are **twenty** common amino acids, each differing by their side chain, represented by R



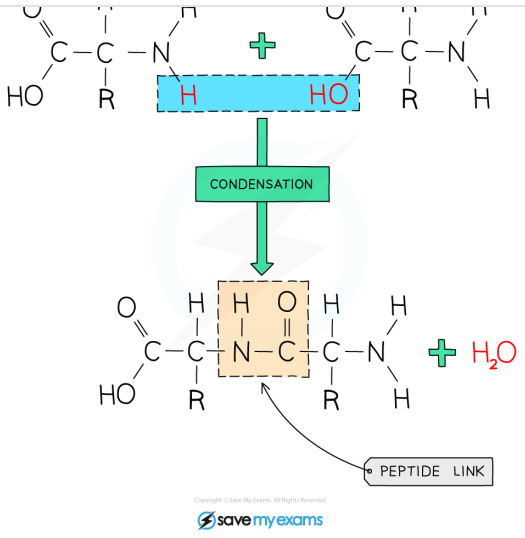
General structure of an amino acid

- Proteins can contain between 60 and 600 of these amino acids in different orders
- These are the monomers which polymerise to form the protein

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it



A protein is produced by a condensation polymerisation reaction

- The structure of proteins can be represented using the following diagram whereby the boxes represent the carbon chains

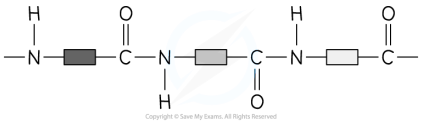


Diagram showing a section of protein

Examiner Tips and Tricks

For your exam, you are only required to draw proteins using the boxes representing the carbon chains.

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